
accelerate
collaborate
innovate
communicate
palm
PalmSource
Conference 2000

Future Tools Strategy

Phillip B. Shoemaker
Director, Development Tools

PalmSource
Conference 2000

The Developer Tools Group

- Mission statement
- Commitment
- Past, Present and Future
- Roles and Responsibilities
- Key Initiatives
- Questions and Answers

Mission Statement

To provide compelling, state of art development tools to internal and external developers of Palm OS-related projects.

Our Commitment

- Powerful development products
- High quality development products
- Support of top three development platforms
- Tool of choice, on the platform of choice
- Delivery and accountability
- Customer satisfaction

Past, Present and Future

The Past

- In 1996, there was no Tools group; In 1997 there was a team of one
- SDKs and CDKs were handbuilt, and never released with OS
- Extensively utilized OS and HotSync resources
- No consistency, API evaluation or sanitization
- One location for developers

Past, Present and Future

The Present

- Tools group consists of three strong sub-teams
- SDKs and CDKs are automated and released simultaneously with OS
- Team of twenty three
- Tools team has staffed up and has removed *reliance* on OS and HotSync teams
- APIs are consistent, evaluated and sanitized
- Development in Santa Clara and Austin

Past, Present and Future

The Future

- Adding more sub-teams
- Enlarge team significantly
- Wireless tools to be developed and released
- Content & Access tools to be developed and released
- Core tools will be Palm-built
- Tools team will support additional development locations

Roles and Responsibilities

- Phillip Shoemaker - Strategic team management
- Robert Sirota - SDK & Application Toolkits
- Eric Omelian - CDK Toolkits
- Phillip Shoemaker (acting) - Big Tools Manager

Key Initiatives

- SDKs
- CDKs
- Palm OS Emulator
- prc-tools
- Resources
- Java
- Big Tools

Software Development Kits

- Headers and libraries
- Sample applications
- Application Frameworks
- Licensee support
- ResEdit support
- Tutorial
- Documentation
- Resource Editor

Conduit Development Kits

- Headers and libraries
- Conduit Frameworks (Generic Conduit)
- Wizards
- Tutorials
- More APIs
- Macintosh and Windows
- COM-enabled development
- Java CDK Update

Palm OS Emulator

- Plug-in support
- Support for all Palm OS devices
- Shipping debug ROM files
- Brain transplant for future processors
- Improved scripting ability (more samples)
- To do list of > 100 pages

Gnu (aka prc-tools)

- Updated Palm OS source
- Updated samples
- Support for future processors
- Continuous improvement to Gnu tools

Resources

Resource Format and Compiler

- New text based resource description (XML-based)
- Cross-platform support
- Command line support for all platforms
- Plug-in support for top development environments
- Multiple language support

Resources

Resource Editor

- Constructor is getting phased out
- Support for variety of platforms:
  - Windows
  - Macintosh
  - Linux
- Standalone and plug-in technologies
- Multiple language support

Java

- Palm is a commercial licensee of J2ME
- Virtual Machine development in-house
- PDA-Profile (PDAp) being led by Palm, Inc.
- Future integration into the top development environments
- MIDp available, but not optimized for the Palm platform
- Working with additional Java partners (we’re not a Java VM house!)

Big Tools
Debugger

- PalmDebugger *'as you know it'* is getting phased out
- New Palm Debugger
- Consists of:
  - Debug engine
  - Plug-in support
- Source level debugging
- Stand-alone and plug-in technologies
- 68k and ARM Support

Big Tools

Compilers and Linkers

- Targeting 68k and ARM
- EDG Front-end
- IR Optimizer and back end technologies acquired from Apogee Software, Inc.
- Tools will be free
- Stand alone technologies on Macintosh, Windows and Linux
- Plug-in technologies on Macintosh and Windows (… waiting on Linux)

Tools Localization

- Development Tools Localization
  - All Palm tools support multi-lingual applications (including double byte languages)
  - Localizable Tools
    - WCA Builder
    - Samples
    - Constructor
    - Simulator
    - Poser
    - CDK Wizards
    - Java Tools
    - Debugger
  - Languages
    - Japanese
    - Chinese

Development Tools Partners

- Metrowerks
- AppForge
- Apogee

If you have a development tool for the Palm OS, we encourage you to approach the development tools team. We can coordinate development, license technology (to and from), and arrange co-marketing.

Accomplishments

- We did:
  - Simultaneous release of SDKs/CDKs
  - Palm resource redesign
  - Windows PalmDebugger
  - Became a commercial licensee of Java
- We didn’t:
  - Release a frameworks
  - Release debug ROM files on CD
  - Release a Windows simulator

Moving Forward...

- We've started an advisor group…
  - We've had our first meeting
  - Palm Tools Advisors (PTA)
  - Meeting Quarterly
  - Different Groups: OS and HotSync focuses
  - Forward us your contact information
- We're demo'ing some important tools…
  - Come to the front for more information…
  - New debugger, new resources, new editor, Java, and more...

Q&A

PalmSource
Conference 2000


accelerate
collaborate
innovate
communicate
palm
PalmSource
Conference 2000